



遠くまで
not more

| 2



09: Alone Is Safer



KAI MORI, 17
Silence by Withdrawal.

REIKA TENDO, 18
Silence by Control.

SORA MINABE, 16
Silence by Fear.

THE DIRECT PATH WOULD
TAKE ME PAST THE COUNCIL
OFFICE.

SHORTER. EASIER.
SMARTER.

SO I TAKE THE LONG WAY.
PAST THE SCIENCE WING.



FUJITA YUKI — 16

PRESENT TRUTH (FLICKERING)

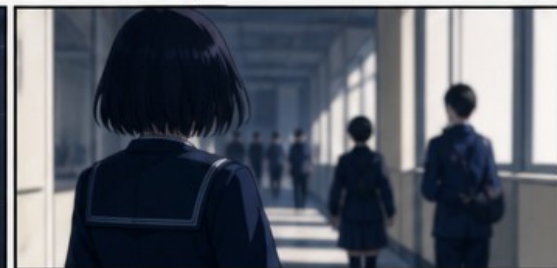
- > HIDING FEVER
- > SKIPPED BREAKFAST
- > WORRIES ABOUT HER MOTHER
- > PRETENDING TO BE FINE



DON'T LOOK.
DON'T READ.



LOOK AT YOUR SHOES.
JUST YOUR SHOES.



I DO HARM WHEN I ACT ON OTHERS' TRUTHS.

BETTER TO KEEP IT TO MYSELF.





STUDENT COUNCIL
OFFICE.
MORNING.



REIKA TENDO, 18.
PRESIDENT,
STUDENT COUNCIL.

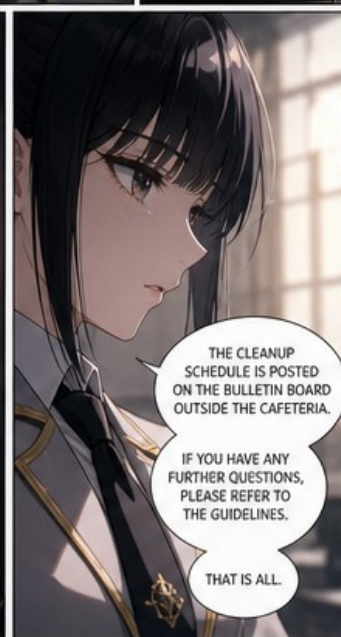
HER PERFECTION
IS ARMOR.

EVERY TASK,
A WALL.



A SIMPLE QUESTION.
A TENTATIVE KNOCK.

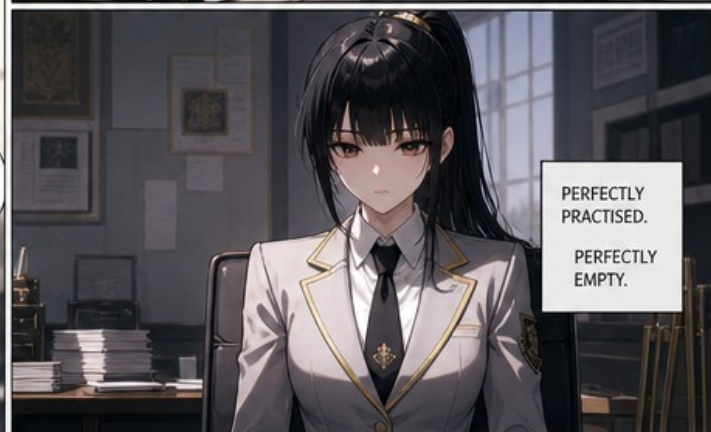
EXCUSE ME...
COULD I ASK ABOUT
THE CULTURE FESTIVAL
CLEANUP SCHEDULE?



THE CLEANUP
SCHEDULE IS POSTED
ON THE BULLETIN BOARD
OUTSIDE THE CAFETERIA.

IF YOU HAVE ANY
FURTHER QUESTIONS,
PLEASE REFER TO
THE GUIDELINES.

THAT IS ALL.



PERFECTLY
PRACTISED.

PERFECTLY
EMPTY.



THE DOOR CLOSES
A BEAT TOO QUICKLY.

click.



ALONE AGAIN.
AS INTENDED.



A BINDER SHE
DOES NOT OPEN.

A GUILT SHE
DOES NOT
SPEAK.

KAISEI HIGH SCHOOL LIBRARY.
LUNCHTIME.

The same
corner.

The same seat.
The same posture.
The same boy.

Before any
of this
began.

Before the gift.
Before the
weight.
Before I
stopped being
invisible.

My gift doesn't
just show me
other people's
futures...

It shows me
what my
presence
does to
them.

More danger.
More pain.
More futures
I wasn't
meant to be
part of.

More harm
I can't stop
because
I'm the
reason it
happens.

So I close
it.

And I don't
open it
again
today.

I thought
staying
meant
protecting
them.

But the future
doesn't lie.

My staying
is the
threat.

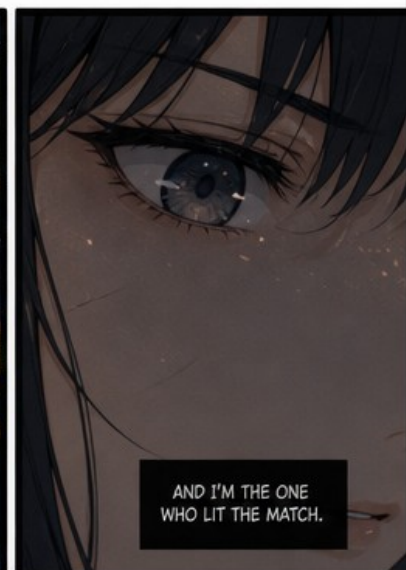
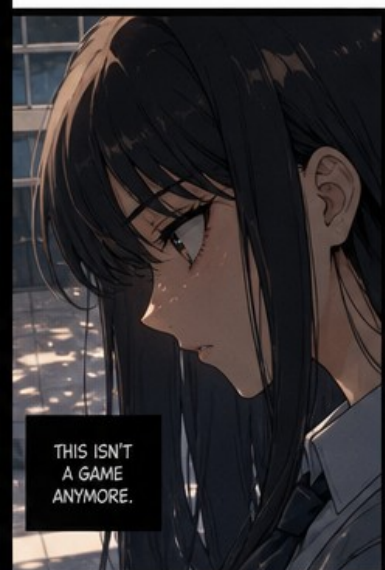
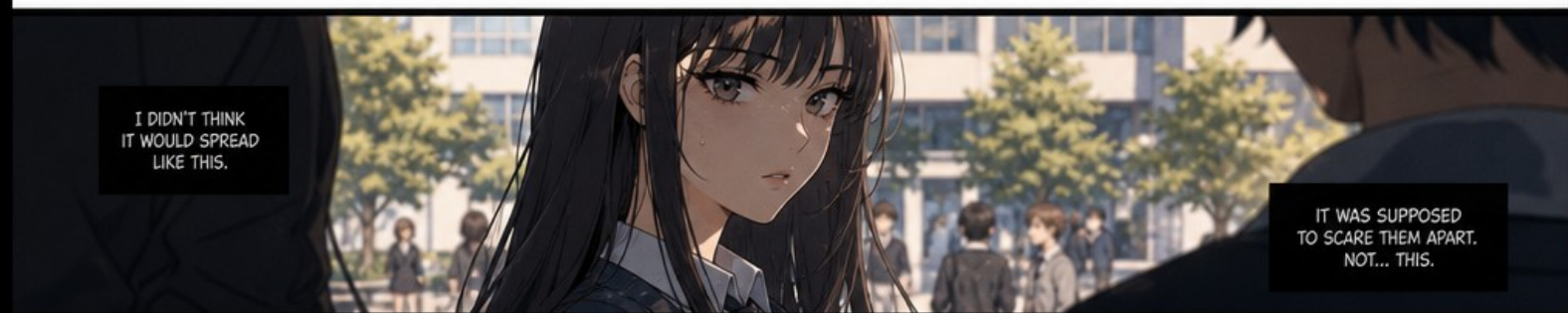
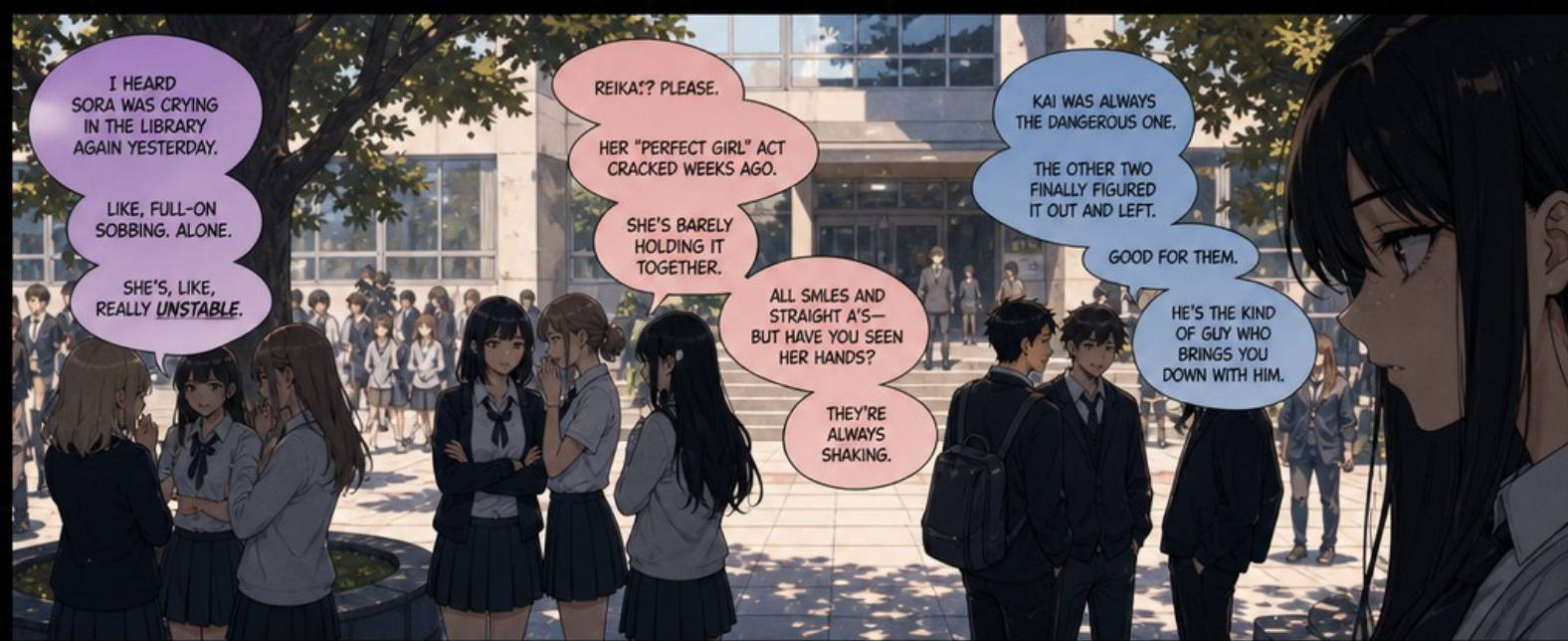
This is where
I started.

This is where
I end.

Not because I
lost...

...but because
I finally listened.

Disappearance
is the only
safe choice
left.



扉が閉まり、
列車は動き出す。

The doors close.
The train
pulls away.



窓に映る自分。
光が流れて、
意識も溶けていく。
My reflection in
the window.
The lights stream by,
and my consciousness
begins to dissolve.



誰も動いていない。
なのに、景色が
わずかに違う。
No one has moved.
And yet,
the scenery
is different.



時計は28分進んでいた。
記憶にない時間。
説明できない空白。
俺の計算が、
初めて追いつかない。
The clock has advanced
28 minutes.
Time I don't remember.
A gap I can't explain.
For the first time,
my calculations
can't keep up.



KAI MORI, 17

DISORIENTED.

THE SPECIFIC
PRACTISED CALM
OF SOMEONE
CONFIRMING HE HAS
NOT LOST ANYTHING
EXCEPT TIME ITSELF.

PHONE.

HANDS.

INTACT.

ADYAMA-
ITTOHOME AKASAKA-
MITSUKE NAGATACHO KOKURITSU
KYOGUO YOYOGI SHINJUKU SHINJUKU-
SANCHOME HIGASHI-
SHINJUKU SHIN-OKUBO TAKADANOKAUSA

HE HAS LOOPED
PAST HIS OWN
STOP TWICE
WITHOUT HIM
DISEMBARKING.

2 LOOPS

TWENTY-EIGHT
MINUTES.

NOT LOST.
ERASED.

THE NUMBERS
ALIGN.

THE PATTERN
PERSISTS.

THE VARIABLE
REMAINS.

DID HE SEE IT?

OR HAS
TWENTY-EIGHT
MINUTES MADE
HIM DOUBT HIS
OWN EYES NOW
TOO?

UNCERTAIN.

IRRITATING.
INEFFICIENT.

BUT DATA
NONETHELESS.

Time	To	Line	Dep.
21:47	SHINJUKU	Y	1
21:50	IKEBUKURO	Y	2
21:53	RETURN	Y	1
21:56	SHIBUYA	Y	2
21:59	MITAKA	Y	1

A SINGLE WORD
FLASHES FOR
EXACTLY ONE
FRAME.

Time	To	Line	Dep.
21:47	SHINJUKU	Y	1
21:50	IKEBUKURO	Y	2
21:53	NAKANO	Y	1
21:56	SHIBUYA	Y	2
21:59	MITAKA	Y	1

HE STEPS OFF
THE TRAIN THIS TIME.

CHOOSING,
FINALLY.

A DIRECTION
RATHER THAN
CONTINUING TO RIDE.

NEAR REIKA'S
NEIGHBOURHOOD
11:07 PM

THE SIGNAL
HAS BEEN RED
FOR FAR TOO
LONG.

I LEFT HOME TO
WALK INSTEAD OF
SITTING WITH THE
SILENCE OF IT.

THE CITY DOESN'T
JUDGE. IT JUST...
CONTINUES.

DOZENS AT
EACH CORNER.

NOBODY
NOTICES.

NOBODY
MINDS.

I CHECK THE TIME.

FORTY
SECONDS.

TECHNICALLY.

00:40.17

BUT IT HAS
FELT LIKE
SEVERAL
MINUTES.

TIME STRETCHES
WHEN YOU CARRY
WHAT I CARRY.

I ABSORB THE
WRONGNESS
OF THE CROWD.

THEIR
INDIFFERENCE.
THEIR INHERITED
GUILT.

IT'S HEAVY.

IT'S MINE.

SHE STEPS
FORWARD
AS IF TO
CROSS.

CATCHES
HERSELF.

STOPS.

A STRANGER.
I'VE NEVER
SEEN HER
BEFORE.

GONE FROM
MY SIGHTLINE
HALF A SECOND
LATER.

SWALLOWED.



THE SIGNAL
FINALLY CHANGES.

THE CROWD
SURGES FORWARD
AS ONE.

REIKA TENDO

18



CARRIED ALONG
IN THE CURRENT
OF BODIES...

NOT BY CHOICE.
NOT BY WILL.

SHE LOOKS DOWN.

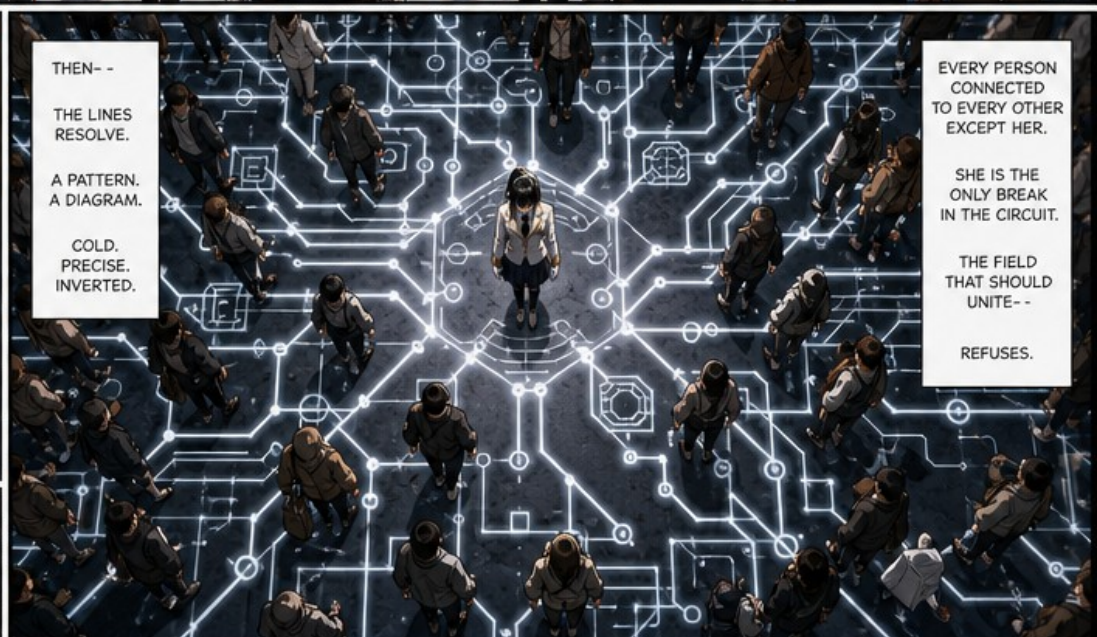
WHITE LINES.
PAINT.
ASPHALT.
NOTHING MORE.

THEN - -

THE LINES
RESOLVE.

A PATTERN.
A DIAGRAM.

COLD.
PRECISE.
INVERTED.

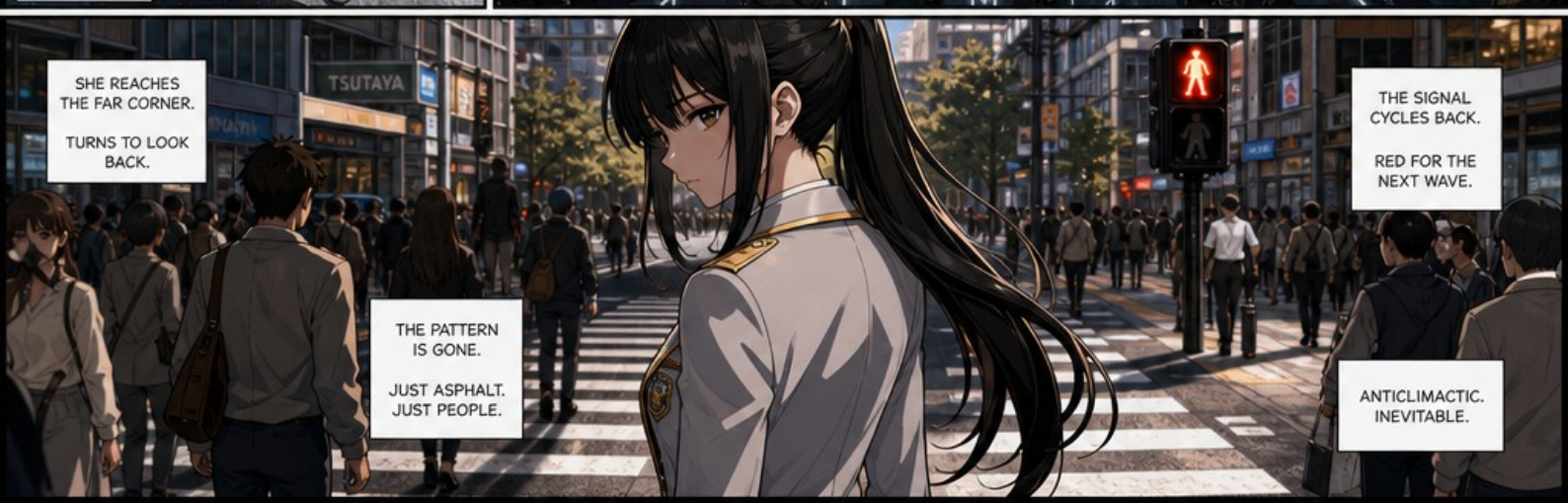


EVERY PERSON
CONNECTED
TO EVERY OTHER
EXCEPT HER.

SHE IS THE
ONLY BREAK
IN THE CIRCUIT.

THE FIELD
THAT SHOULD
UNITE - -

REFUSES.



SHE REACHES
THE FAR CORNER.
TURNS TO LOOK
BACK.

THE PATTERN
IS GONE.
JUST ASPHALT.
JUST PEOPLE.

THE SIGNAL
CYCLES BACK.

RED FOR THE
NEXT WAVE.

ANTICLIMACTIC.
INEVITABLE.



I WALKED HERE
WITHOUT QUITE
DECIDING TO.



KAI MORI.
17.

NO ONE
SEATS THEMSELVES
IN SOMEONE ELSE'S
BOOTH.

NOT HERE.



I LOOKED AWAY
FOR TWENTY
SECONDS.



NO ONE
LOOKED.

NO ONE
MOVED.

AS IF IT HAD
ALWAYS BEEN
LIKE THIS.



MY EYES DID THE
THING THEY ALWAYS
DO FIRST.

MAP. CLASSIFY.
PREDICT.

THE GRID SLID
ACROSS HIM—

—AND FELL
THROUGH.



You've been
answering the
wrong question.



1

CLOSING.
OPENING.

THE SAME
MOTION,
AGAIN AND
AGAIN.

LIKE
DECIDING
SOMETHING
WITHOUT
DECIDING
ANYTHING.

2

EXHAUSTION
SETTLES
IN DEEPER
THAN BONE.

FRACTURE-DREAD.
SELF-ERASURE.
COMPOUNDED.

ALL DAY.
EVERY DAY.

UNTIL IT
BECOMES
SOMETHING
WORSE.

3

SETTING IT
DOWN.
DELIBERATELY.

CHOOSING, IN
THIS SMALL
DARK MOMENT,
TO SIMPLY
STOP TRYING.

NOT DRAMATIC.
NOT LOUD.

JUST QUIET.

JUST A BOY
DECIDING THAT
DISAPPEARING
MIGHT STILL
BE THE KINDEST
OPTION LEFT.

4

ONE LAST
LINE OF
STREETLIGHT.

ONE LAST
REASON
TO KEEP
GOING.



A KNOCK.
QUIET. HESITANT.
AT AN HOUR NO
ONE REASONABLY
VISITS.

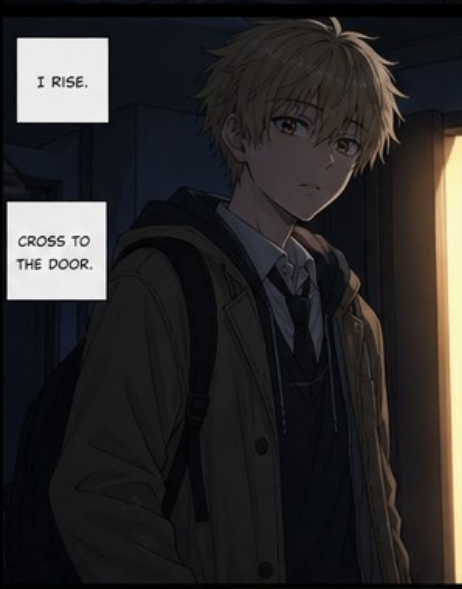
I DON'T
MOVE.



KNOCK.

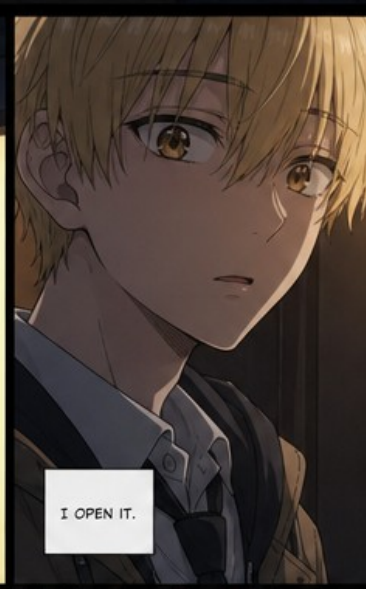


KNOCK.



I RISE.

CROSS TO
THE DOOR.



I OPEN IT.



YOU SAW ME.
AT THE GATE.

BEFORE ANYONE
ELSE DID.

I WANTED TO SAY
I SAW YOU TOO.

SORA
MINABE

16 YEARS OLD

CLASS 2-1



FUJITA
YUKI

16 YEARS OLD

CLASS 2-3



SAME HOUR.
SAME PLACE.
NO ONE COMES.

THE OLD WING
REMAINS SEALED.

THE SCHOOL
REMAINS DARK.

IT DOES NOT WAIT.

IT DOES NOT ASK.

IT DOES NOT NEED.

IT GROWS
IN THE SILENCE
BETWEEN THEM.

IT OUTGREW
THEIR REACH
LONG AGO.

It did not need them divided to keep growing.
It only needed them apart long enough not to notice.